Video 09 | Bass Sounds

Massive PSXL instructional series - video script

Runtime estimate	Narration length	Scenes	Format
about 4:44 minutes	660 words at 150 words per minute	12	Screen capture of the plug-in with voice-over; dark theme, interface size 125 percent

Learning goals

- Build a sub, a wobble, an acid line and a reese from Load Init (Blank).
- Use LFO sync, legato and glide, and detuned unison stacks.

NOTE. Accuracy rule for the narrator and any generated video: use the on-screen names exactly as written in the action column. After **Load Init (Blank)** the synth is silent until routing is connected. Do not compare Massive PSXL to other products.

Scene table

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
1	Load Init (Blank), quick setup Osc 1 + Osc 2 > Filter 1 > Out. Osc 1 Morph Basic Pos 0. Osc 2 table Morph Basic, Pos 0, Pitch -12, Level 0.5.	Bass is about the low end, so let us begin with a sub. Quick setup with both oscillators. Osc 1 as a sine. On Osc 2, change the table to Morph Basic, because it starts on Pulse Sweep, then pitch down twelve and level to half. Sub bass is the foundation, so we keep it simple: sines and a low-pass filter. Complexity can come later.	Highlight the Osc 2 table menu.
2	Filter 1 Ladder LP 24, Cutoff 380, Reso 0.1; Amp Env Attack 0.004, Decay 0.3, Sustain 0.95, Release 0.18. Play low notes.	Filter one: ladder low-pass at three hundred eighty, a touch of resonance. Amp envelope with high sustain. Play low and feel it. For small speakers, add the Insert with TanH after the filter, drive thirty-five percent, mix sixty percent, so there are harmonics to hear. Always check a bass on more than one speaker system. A very low sine can be felt but not heard on laptop speakers, which is why harmonics from the insert are so useful.	Low-frequency meter or spectrum overlay.
3	Set Voice Mode Mono, Glide 0.05 on the Pitch panel; play a slide.	Switch the voice mode to Mono and use a little glide for 808-style slides. In mono mode each new note retriggers the envelopes and slides from the last pitch. If you want slides that do not retrigger, use legato mode, which we will use for the acid line.	Show the Voice Mode menu.
4	New: Init (Blank), Osc 1 > Filter 1 > Out. Osc 1 Morph Basic Pos 0.66, Unison 3, Detune 10. Filter Ladder LP 24 Cutoff 520 Reso 0.5 Drive 0.2.	Wobble. Init Blank, Osc 1 into Filter 1 into Out. A saw, unison three, detune ten. Ladder low-pass at five twenty, resonance half, a little drive. Unison with a small detune gives the saw some width. For a wobble, a little detune is plenty, since the movement will come from the filter.	Hover readouts.

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
5	Mod 2: Type LFO, Shape Sine, Sync on, Division 1/8. Drag chip onto Filter 1 Cutoff; amount +0.34. Try Division 1/4, 1/16.	Open Mod 2, make it an LFO with a sine shape, switch Sync on, and choose eighths. Drag the chip onto Cutoff with plus point three four. That is a wobble locked to your tempo. Try quarter notes for dub, sixteenths for aggression. The depth of the wobble depends on both the base cutoff and the amount. If the wobble disappears at the lowest point, raise the base cutoff a little or lower the amount.	Overlay a metronome and the LFO display.
6	Pitch panel: Voice Mode Legato, Glide 0.07. Filter 1 Cutoff 560, Reso 0.72, Drive 0.35. Mod 2 back to Envelope: Attack 0.002, Decay 0.2, Sustain 0, Release 0.15, chip to Cutoff +0.34.	Acid. Legato mode with a short glide. Cutoff five sixty, resonance point seven two, drive thirty-five percent. Mod 2 as a fast envelope on the cutoff. Overlapping notes slide and detached notes pluck. That is the whole trick. The envelope here is very short and sustain is zero, so each note has a snap. With a long note the filter closes again, leaving the resonant tail of the oscillator.	Show two overlapping notes then two detached notes in a piano roll.
7	Drag Velocity chip onto Cutoff +0.2. Play soft and hard notes.	Add accents. Drag the Velocity chip onto cutoff and play some notes harder. Because velocity is a voice source, each note has its own value. Pressing harder opens the filter more on that note.	Show velocity bars.
8	New: Init (Blank), quick setup Osc 1 + Osc 2 > Filter 1 > Out. Osc 1: Pos 0.66 Unison 4 Detune 24. Osc 2: Morph Basic, Pos 0.66, Fine +9, Unison 4, Detune 20.	Reese. Two oscillators on the saw position, both with four voices, detuned by different amounts, and Osc 2 nine cents out. Remember to switch Osc 2 to Morph Basic. Two detuned stacks beating against each other is the heart of the reese. The fine control on Osc 2 changes the speed of the beating, so try values from plus five to plus fifteen.	Show Osc 2 tab.
9	Filter 1 Cutoff 1000 Reso 0.2; Mod 2 LFO Triangle Rate 0.3 Hz to Cutoff +0.12; Chorus Mix 0.25.	Ladder at one thousand. A slow triangle LFO, point three hertz, on the cutoff, plus point one two. Chorus mix a quarter for width. The movement is the beating between the two stacks. Slow modulation is the secret. At point three hertz the filter takes about three seconds per cycle, so it feels like the bass is breathing.	Show Chor tab.
10	Add Insert: wire Filter 1 > Insert > Out; Fold, Drive 0.4, Mix 0.4.	For more growl, wire Filter 1 into the Insert and out, fold with drive point four and mix point four. Add a little fold or tanh after the filter and the reese gets a growl. Because the insert comes after the filter, it distorts the filtered signal, which is the sound you want here.	Highlight routing change.
11	Browse > Bass: click Sub Pillar, Wobble Machine, Acid Line, Reese Beast.	To compare, open Browse and the Bass category: Sub Pillar, Wobble Machine, Acid Line and Reese Beast. Press Mutate under the Menu to explore variations. Try pressing Mutate on any of these patches. It will randomise the continuous voice parameters a little, which is a quick way to discover variations. Undo takes it back.	Highlight the Mutate menu item.
12	End card.	Four basses, the same few tools. Next, leads and pads.	End card: 'Next: 10 Leads and pads'.

Narration only (plain script for text-to-speech or NotebookLM)

[Scene 1] Bass is about the low end, so let us begin with a sub. Quick setup with both oscillators. Osc 1 as a sine. On Osc 2, change the table to Morph Basic, because it starts on Pulse Sweep, then pitch down twelve and level to half. Sub bass is the foundation, so we keep it simple: sines and a low-pass filter. Complexity can come later.

[Scene 2] Filter one: ladder low-pass at three hundred eighty, a touch of resonance. Amp envelope with high sustain. Play low and feel it. For small speakers, add the Insert with TanH after the filter, drive thirty-five percent, mix sixty percent, so there are harmonics to hear. Always check a bass on more than one speaker system. A very low sine can be felt but not heard on laptop speakers, which is why harmonics from the insert are so useful.

[Scene 3] Switch the voice mode to Mono and use a little glide for 808-style slides. In mono mode each new note retriggers the envelopes and slides from the last pitch. If you want slides that do not retrigger, use legato mode, which we will use for the acid line.

[Scene 4] Wobble. Init Blank, Osc 1 into Filter 1 into Out. A saw, unison three, detune ten. Ladder low-pass at five twenty, resonance half, a little drive. Unison with a small detune gives the saw some width. For a wobble, a little detune is plenty, since the movement will come from the filter.

[Scene 5] Open Mod 2, make it an LFO with a sine shape, switch Sync on, and choose eighths. Drag the chip onto Cutoff with plus point three four. That is a wobble locked to your tempo. Try quarter notes for dub, sixteenths for aggression. The depth of the wobble depends on both the base cutoff and the amount. If the wobble disappears at the lowest point, raise the base cutoff a little or lower the amount.

[Scene 6] Acid. Legato mode with a short glide. Cutoff five sixty, resonance point seven two, drive thirty-five percent. Mod 2 as a fast envelope on the cutoff. Overlapping notes slide and detached notes pluck. That is the whole trick. The envelope here is very short and sustain is zero, so each note has a snap. With a long note the filter closes again, leaving the resonant tail of the oscillator.

[Scene 7] Add accents. Drag the Velocity chip onto cutoff and play some notes harder. Because velocity is a voice source, each note has its own value. Pressing harder opens the filter more on that note.

[Scene 8] Reese. Two oscillators on the saw position, both with four voices, detuned by different amounts, and Osc 2 nine cents out. Remember to switch Osc 2 to Morph Basic. Two detuned stacks beating against each other is the heart of the reese. The fine control on Osc 2 changes the speed of the beating, so try values from plus five to plus fifteen.

[Scene 9] Ladder at one thousand. A slow triangle LFO, point three hertz, on the cutoff, plus point one two. Chorus mix a quarter for width. The movement is the beating between the two stacks. Slow modulation is the secret. At point three hertz the filter takes about three seconds per cycle, so it feels like the bass is breathing.

[Scene 10] For more growl, wire Filter 1 into the Insert and out, fold with drive point four and mix point four. Add a little fold or tanh after the filter and the reese gets a growl. Because the insert comes after the filter, it distorts the filtered signal, which is the sound you want here.

[Scene 11] To compare, open Browse and the Bass category: Sub Pillar, Wobble Machine, Acid Line and Reese Beast. Press Mutate under the Menu to explore variations. Try pressing Mutate on any of these patches. It will randomise the continuous voice parameters a little, which is a quick way to discover variations. Undo takes it back.

[Scene 12] Four basses, the same few tools. Next, leads and pads.

> **TIP.** Pause for about one second between scenes and let on-screen actions finish before the next sentence starts.